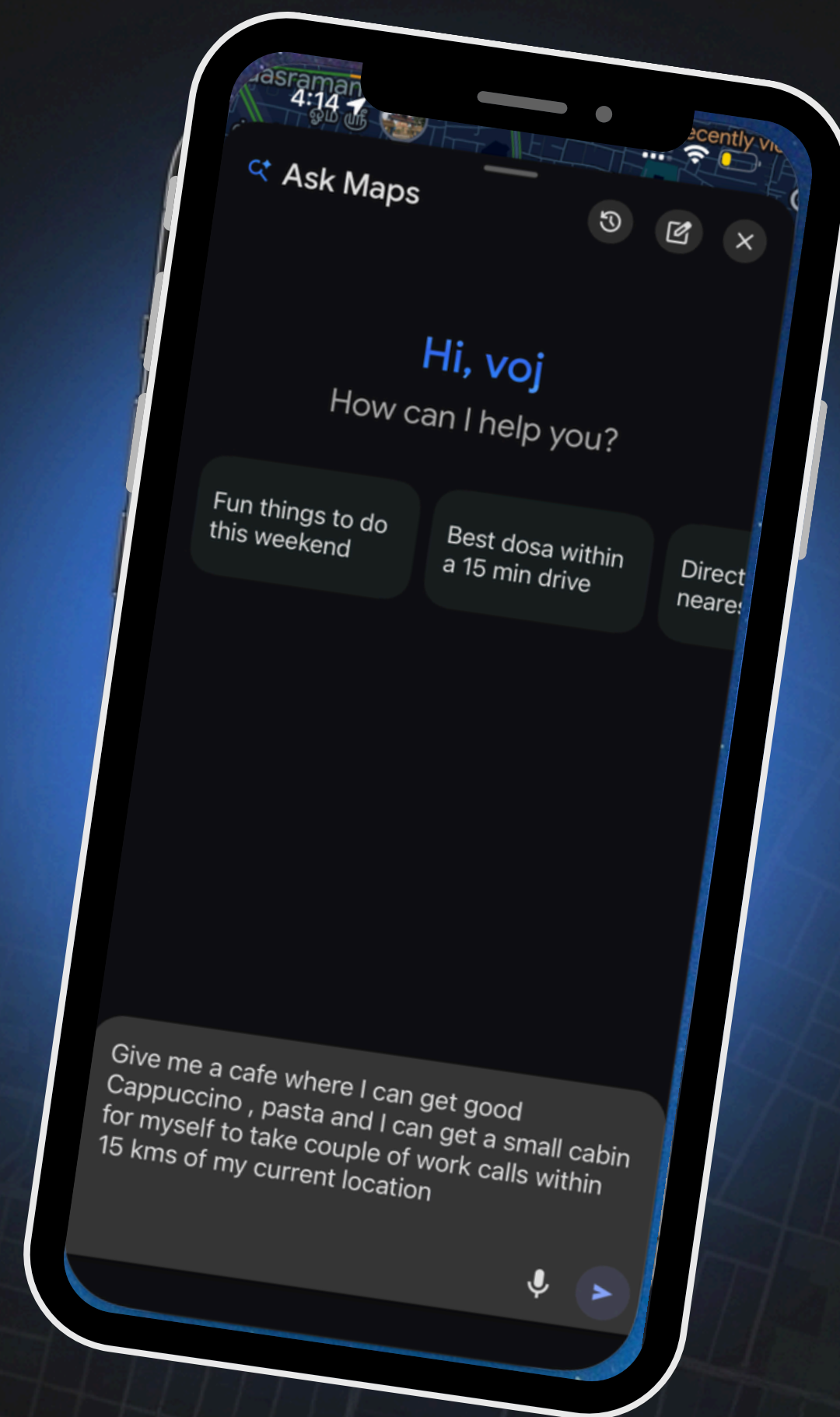


Ask Maps

A Product Teardown

Gemini-Powered Conversational Discovery · India Market Focus · April 2026



2B+

Monthly Active Users globally

220+

Countries & territories covered

~60M+

Users in India-largest contributor

300M+

Places in the database

What is Google Maps?

Google Maps is a web mapping platform and consumer app offering satellite imagery, street maps, 360° panoramic views, real-time traffic, and local business information for 220+ countries.

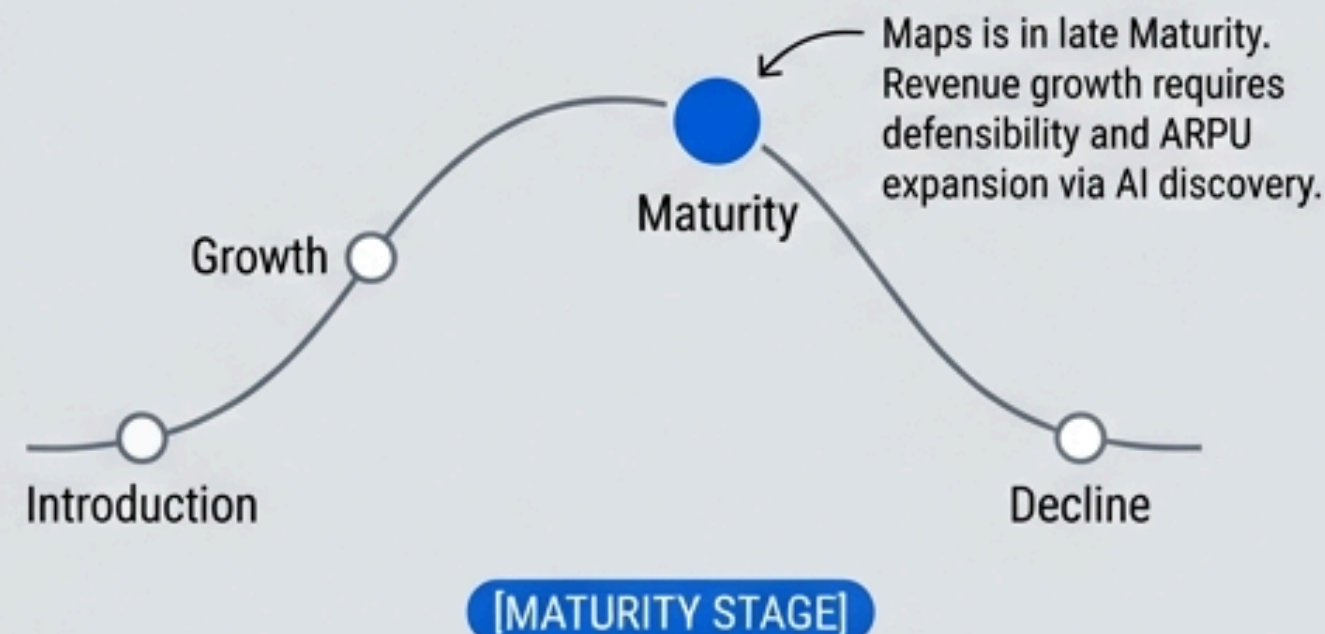
VISION

To provide people with the most comprehensive, accurate, and usable map of the world.

MISSION

Help people navigate and discover the world — wherever they are.

Where is Maps in the PLC?



Competitor Landscape

GLOBAL

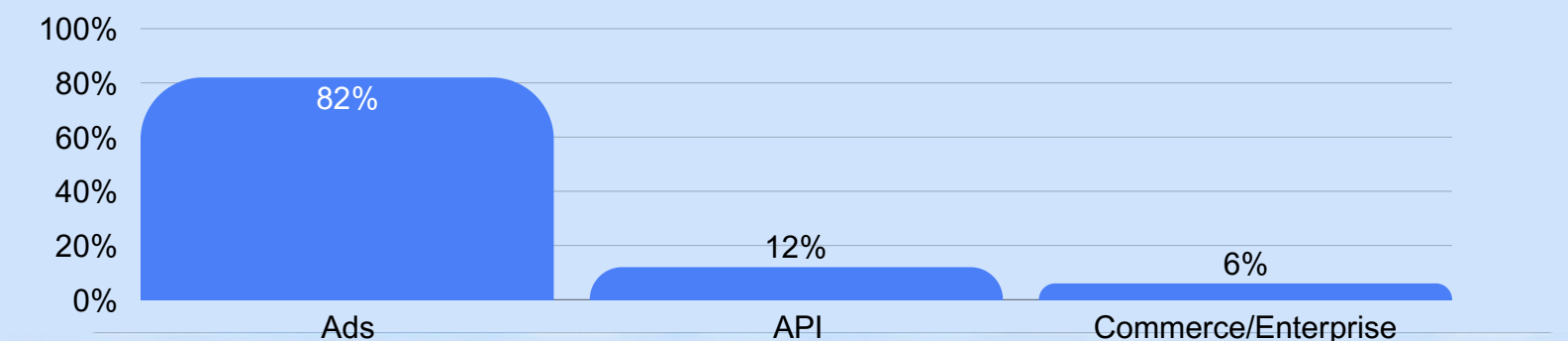
Direct: Apple Maps, Waze, HERE Maps
Indirect: ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google Search

INDIA-SPECIFIC

Direct: Mappls, Ola Maps
Indirect: Zomato, Swiggy

! Mappls has ISRO partnership + MoD contracts. Government procurement risk is real.

- 💰 Google Maps Platform (API)
- 📢 Local Search Advertising
- 🛒 Commerce Integration
- 🗺️ Enterprise Licensing

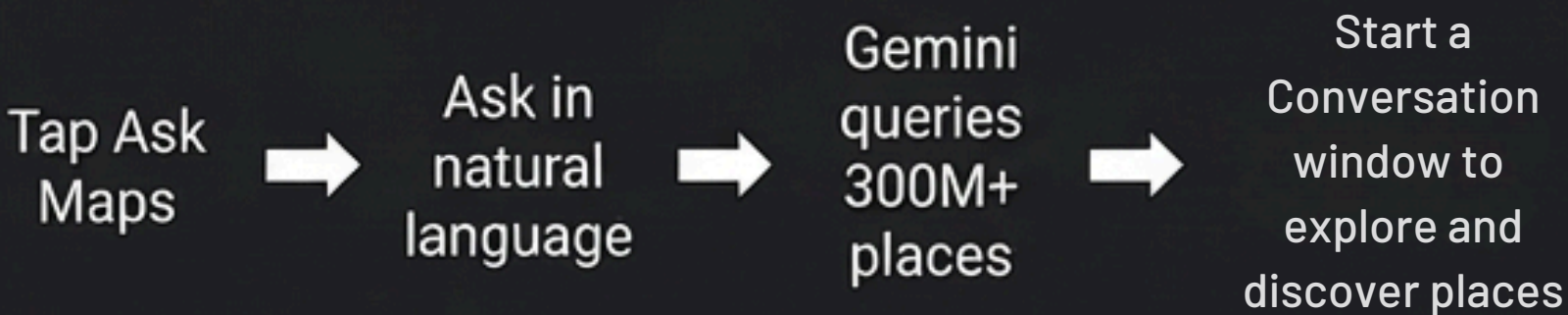


Google Maps Platform estimated ~ \$1.4B-\$2B annual revenue. Full Maps revenue unreported.

ASK MAPS — WHAT IT IS, WHY NOW, WHY DIFFERENT

What Is Ask Maps?

Ask Maps is a Gemini-powered conversational feature inside Google Maps that allows users to ask complex, real-world questions in natural language and receive AI-generated answers inside a chat window



India + US

Android + iOS

Launched March 12, 2026

4 Catalysts for Launch

- 1. **AI Arms Race** — ChatGPT & Perplexity threat.
- 2. **Gemini Maturity** — 3.1 Pro handles multi-constraint queries.
- 3. **Shifted User Expectations** — Keyword search feels outdated.
- 4. **Monetisation Expansion** — New ad surfaces & commerce.

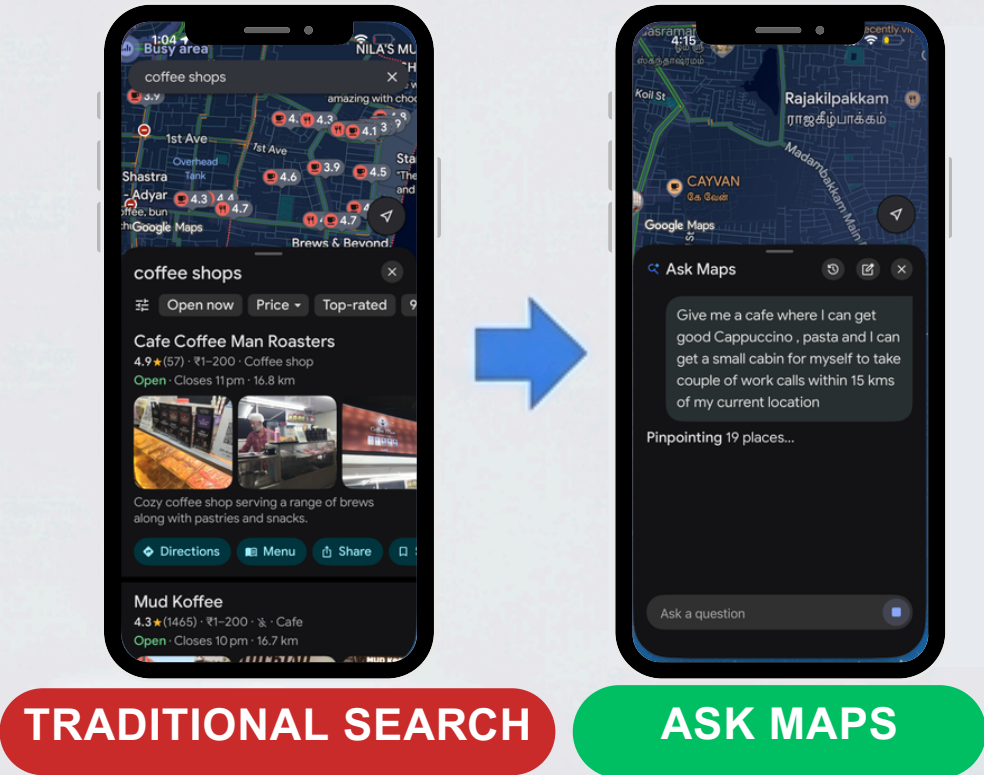
India-specific: 50M+ daily local searches. Hindi support launching.

Traditional Search vs. Ask Maps

	Traditional Search	Ask Maps
Input	Keywords	Natural language
Output	Ranked list + pins	Conversational Window
Refinement	New search	Follow-up question

The shift is from retrieval to reasoning.

Phone Wireframe



USER PERSONAS — WHO USES ASK MAPS?

Rahul

Business Traveler

Time-Pressed

Tier-1 metros

28-40 years old

Senior professional

Ask Maps Usage: Occasional. Values speed.

Priya

Family Planner

Safety-Conscious

Suburban metros

Married with children

Plans outings

Ask Maps Usage: Moderate. Multi-constraint queries fit well.

Arjun

Casual Browser

Low Intent

College towns

18-25 years old

Reactive user

Ask Maps Usage: Low. High drop-off risk.

ICP ★

Ananya

Urban Explorer

Tech-Savvy

Social Amplifier

Mumbai/Bengaluru

22-32 years old

Daily Maps user
Instagram + WhatsApp sharer

Anxiety: Showing up somewhere and it being wrong / bad.

Power user profile. Multi-constraint queries are her natural language.

Why Ask Maps must nail Ananya before targeting mass adoption

Highest Frequency

No Education Needed

Full Feature Utilisation

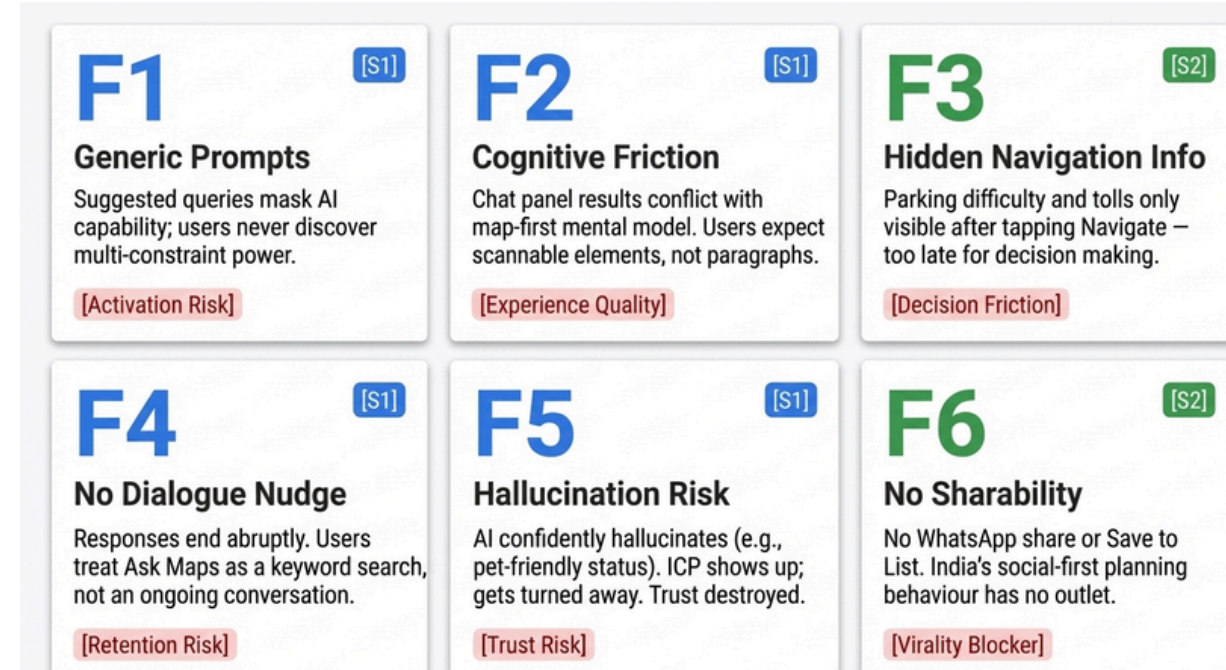
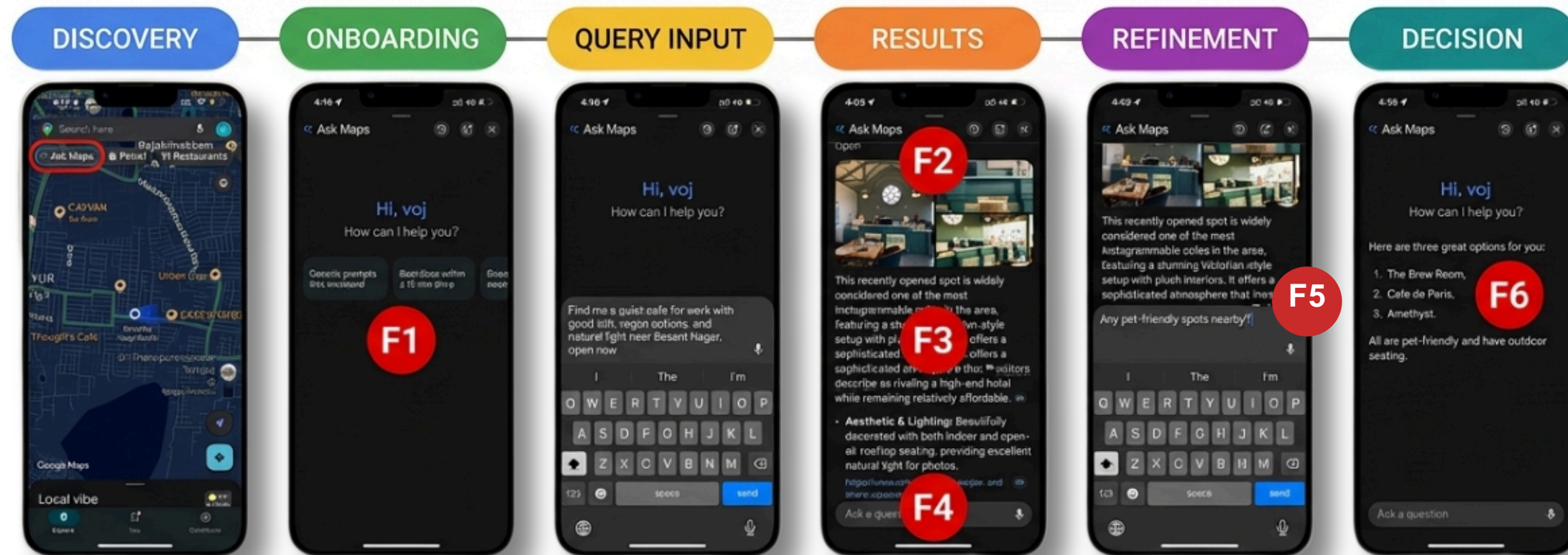
Social Amplifier

Monetisation Upside

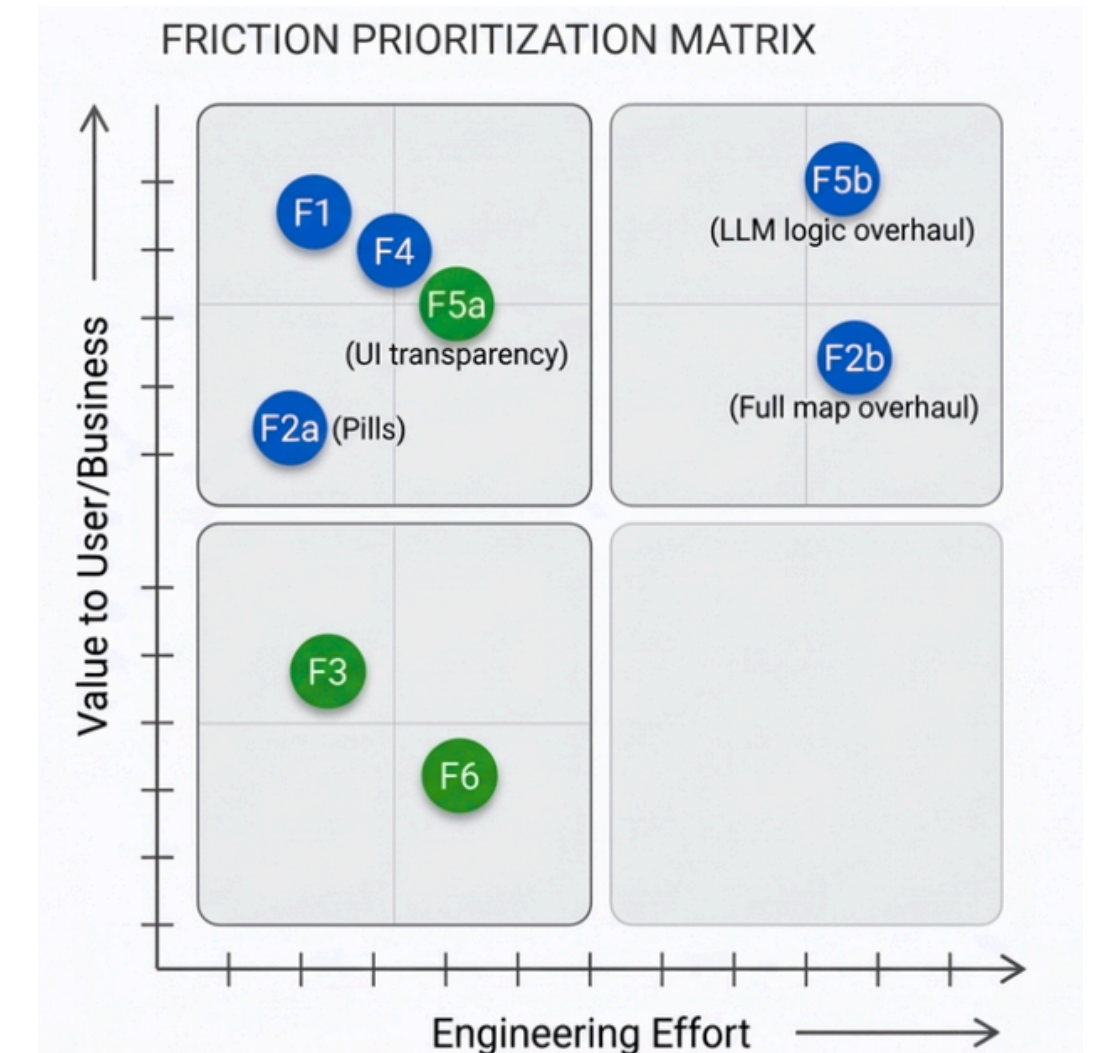
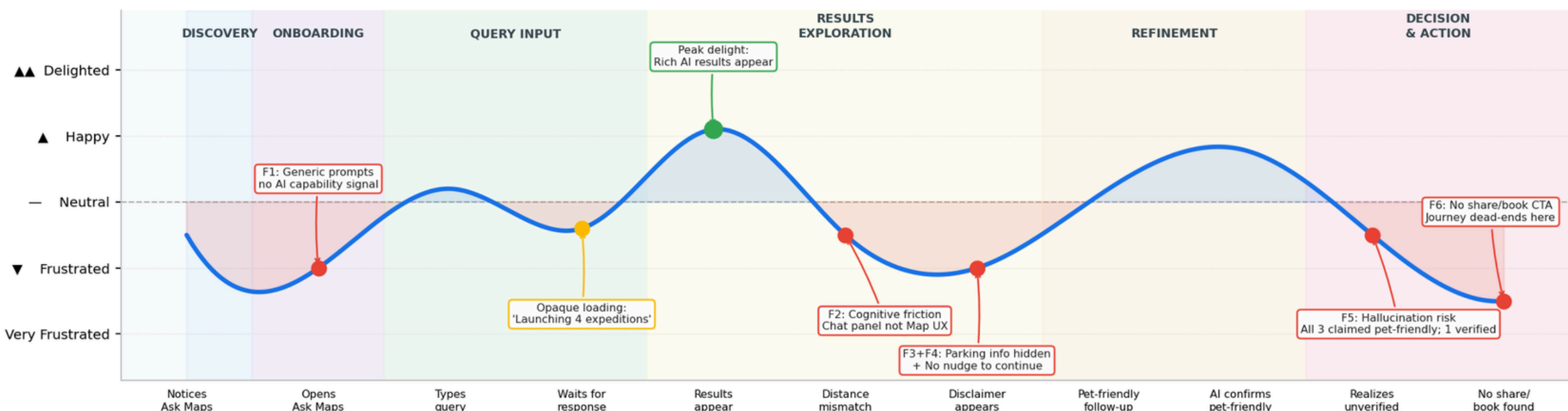
Compounding Retention

She is also the liability: one hallucination that she shares publicly = negative viral reach.

USER JOURNEY AND FRICTION POINTS PRIORITY

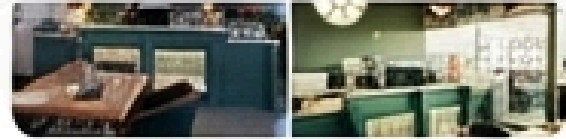


Doing	Sees chip	Taps prompt	Types detailed query	Scans results	Types follow-up	Looks for share
Thinking	Is this a filter?	Not relevant	Will it work?	Text heavy	Cool it remembered	No share button?
Feeling	😞	🤔	😞	😊	😊	😞



SOLUTIONS — SPRINT 1 FIXES (1 OF 2)

BEFORE: 70+ words. No source attribution.



This recently opened spet is widely considered one of the most instagrammable cafes in the area, featuring a stunning Victorian-style setup with plush interiors. It offers a sophisticated atmosphere that a sephisticated atmosphere that P yjsiters describe as rivaling a high-end hotel while remaining relatively affordable. 

Ask a question 

S-01: Query-Anchored Attribute Pills [Sprint 1]

Fixes: F2a Cognitive Friction + F5a Hallucination Risk

Replace prose result summaries with scannable, confidence-coded attribute pills derived from the user's query terms.

The UI does the trust work, not a disclaimer.

AFTER

Brews & Beyond, Besant N...  

Open till 11pm ✓

Instagrammable ✓

 Parking – street only · 3 reviews

 Pet friendly · 2 mentions

Replace prose result summaries with scannable, confidence-coded attribute pills derived from the user's query terms.

BEFORE

Fun things to do
this weekend

Best dosa within
a 15 min drive

Directions to the
nearest public t...

Plan a tour of
historic places...

S-02: Dynamic Query Showcase [Sprint 1]

Fixes: F1 Generic Prompts

Replace generic onboarding prompts with context-aware, multi-constraint examples that demonstrate actual capability.

Show, don't tell — the prompt IS the feature demo.

AFTER

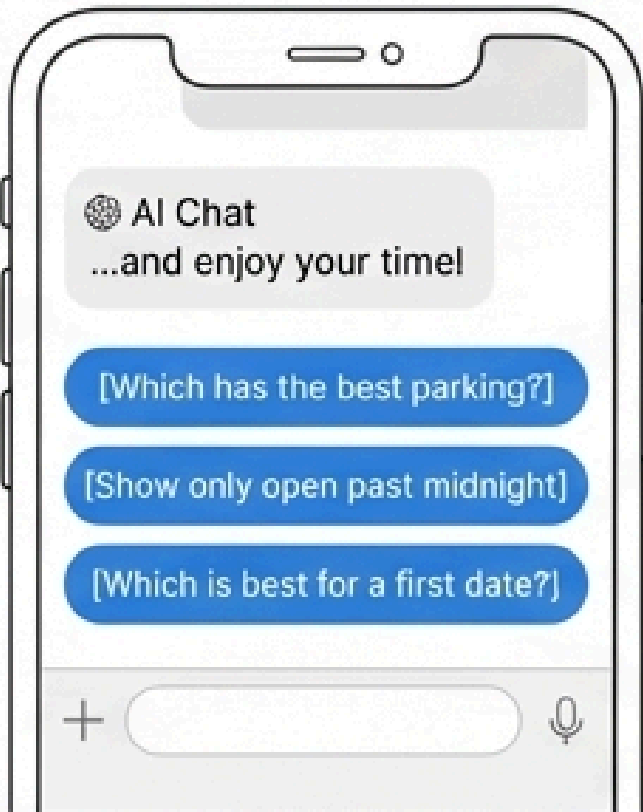
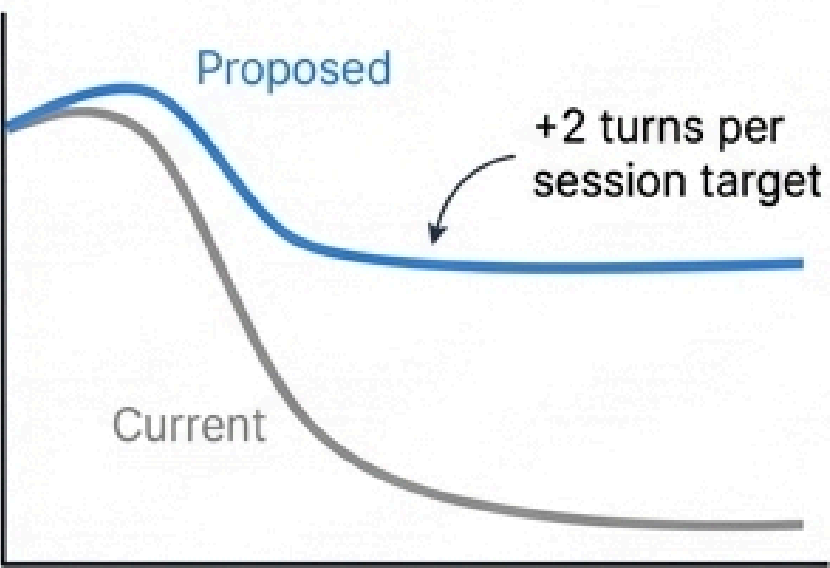
Find a rooftop cafe
with live music, open
tonight, under ₹800

Best Instagrammable
brunch, vegan-
friendly, Bandra

Plan a 3-day itinerary
for a family with kids
in Kyoto, including
transport

Suggest a romantic
dinner spot with a
view and vegetarian
options for Friday

Conversation Continuity

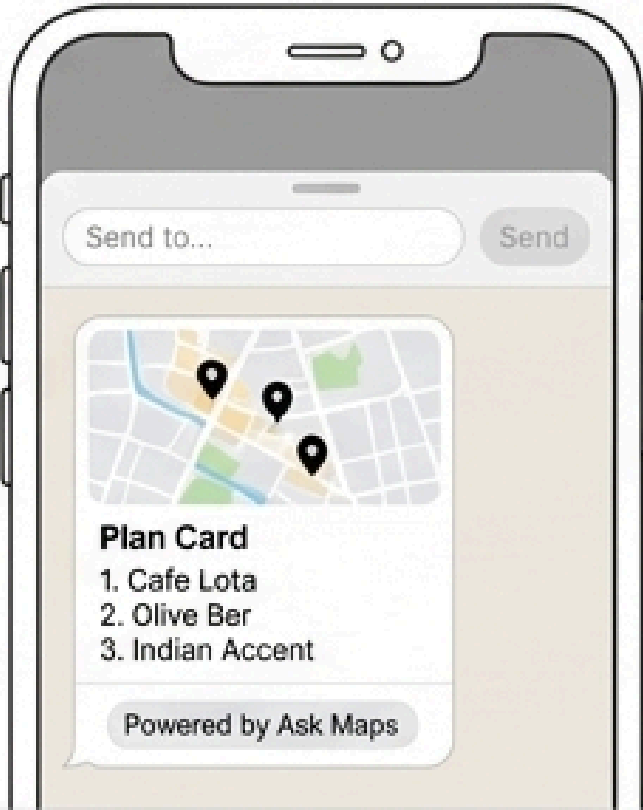
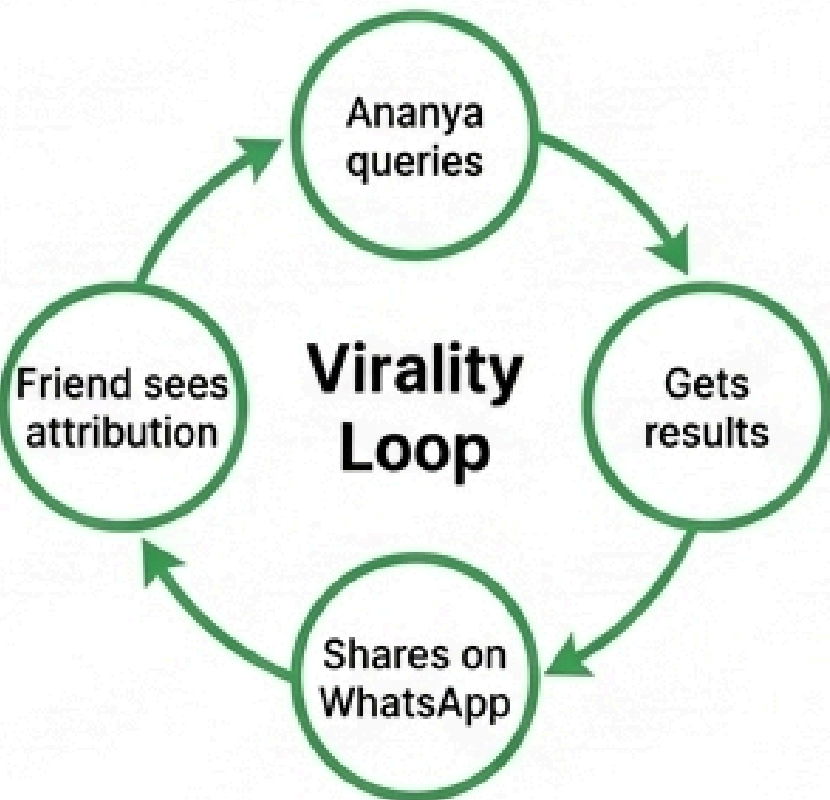


S-03: Conversation Continuity Nudge Sprint 1

Fixes: F4 No Dialogue Nudge

Append 3 contextual follow-up suggestion chips at the end of every Ask Maps response to turn dead-ends into doorways.

“Every response ends with a door, not a wall.”



S-04: Quick Share Plan [Sprint 2]

Fixes: F6 No Shareability

One-tap WhatsApp share feature generating an attributed plan card with mini-map and shortlist.

“Ananya sharing her plan IS the acquisition engine.”

PLAN TO WIN — GTM · METRICS · RISKS · GUARDRAILS

GTM SWIMLANE

Fix & Validate (Wks 1-4)

Target: 5% ICP cohort.

✓ **Gate:** Follow-up Rate >25%

Activation Push (Wks 5-10)

Target: Metro ICPs via
tooltips & influencers.

✓ **Gate:** Activation Rate >15%

Virality (Wks 11-16)

Target: WhatsApp
sharing & Hindi launch.

✓ **Gate:** Share Rate >20%

NORTH STAR METRIC

Weekly active users completing 2+ Ask Maps sessions with at least one follow-up question asked.

Activation Rate

>15%

(Target segment who submit at least 1 query)

[Activation]

Follow-up Rate

>30%

(Sessions with 2+ turns)

[Engagement]

Avg Turns/Session

>2.0

(Conversation depth)

[Engagement]

Pill Interaction

>35%

(Users verifying sources via UI)

[Feature Adoption]

D7 Retention

>40%

(Return within 7 days)

[Retention]

D30 Retention

>25%

(Still using in month 2)

[Retention]

Trust Score

>80% positive

(Thumbs up / total feedback)

[Quality]

Navigation Start

>55%

(Directions tapped)

[Conversion]

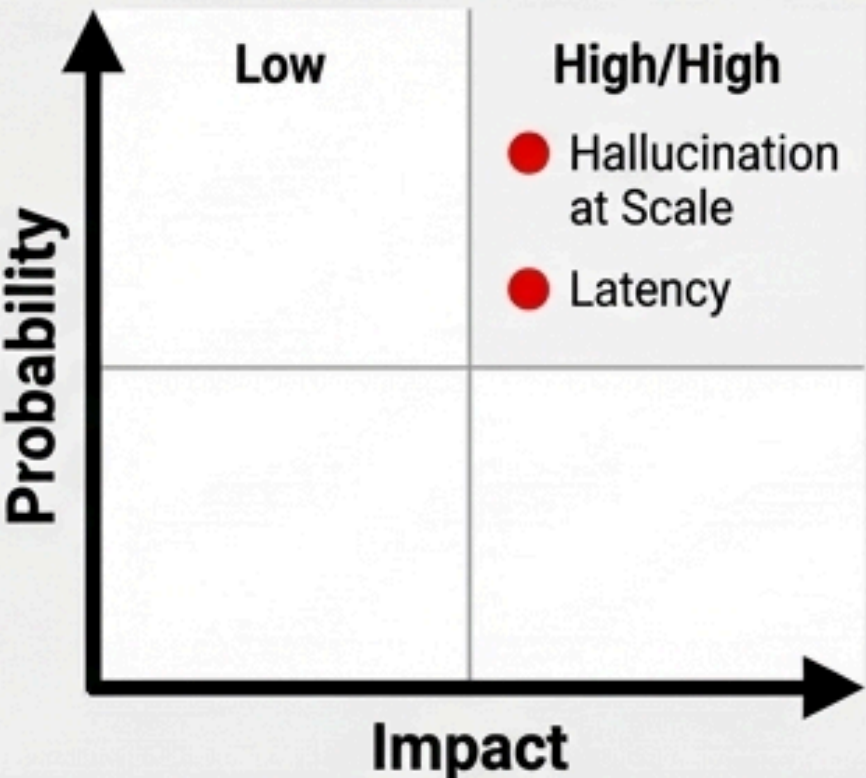
Share Rate

>15%

(Plans shared externally - Sprint 2)

[Virality]

RISKS & GUARDRAILS



Guardrails



Trust Floor: Pause
Green pills if score <70%



Data Freshness:
Downgrade >30 days old



Response Latency:
Fallback if >45s



Ask Maps

A Product Teardown

[Fix trust before scaling reach]

[Ananya's share IS the GTM]

[The ICP is also the liability]